

Image Style Library

32 styles grouped by visual similarity, with key differentiators

Warm & painterly

Soft brushwork, inviting light, emotional atmosphere

Studio Ghibli

nature · wonder · outdoors

Lush, handcrafted environments. Dappled sunlight, golden afternoon, misty mornings. The world breathes.

vs Ember: Ghibli is nature and daylight; Ember is interiors and candlefire. Ghibli feels vast, Ember feels intimate.

vs Aquarelle: Ghibli has rich saturated environments; Aquarelle is quieter and more restrained.

Ember

taverns · candlelight · intimacy

Amber-lit dark fantasy interiors. Warmth as the dominant emotion. Feels safe despite the darkness behind it.

vs Ghibli: Same warmth, totally different setting. Ember lives inside at night; Ghibli lives outside in daylight.

vs Storybook: Both warm, but Ember is darker and anime-rendered; Storybook is watercolour and child-safe.

Aquarelle

watercolour · restraint · OC portraits

Delicate watercolour anime. Rough linework, faint paper texture, generous negative space. Characters feel unconventional.

vs Gossamer: Aquarelle has analog texture and warmth; Gossamer is clean digital with a cool, nearly shadowless finish.

vs Storybook: Aquarelle is anime and character-forward; Storybook is illustrated children's book.

Storybook

fairy tales · animals · wonder

Gouache/watercolour washes over ink linework. Warm ochres, dusty roses, cream. Safe, wonder-filled, clearly readable compositions.

vs Aquarelle: Storybook is children's illustration energy; Aquarelle is anime with analog texture.

vs Daily Chibi: Storybook has environments and fairy-tale framing; Daily Chibi is modern anime slice-of-life indoors.

Storybook Impasto

thick gouache · textured · handcrafted

Heavier, more tactile Storybook variant. Thick opaque gouache, visible dry-brush strokes, prominent paper texture. Flat matte colour blocks, no glossy or digital sheen anywhere.

vs Storybook: Same warm palette and whimsy, but Impasto has thick visible brushwork and paper texture; Storybook is smoother digital watercolour.

vs Aquarelle: Both have analog texture, but Impasto is children's illustration with heavy paint; Aquarelle is anime with delicate washes.

Makoto Shinkai

skies · longing · golden hour

Hyper-detailed atmospheric skies, volumetric light rays, intensely saturated colour. Photographic backgrounds, clean anime characters.

vs Ghibli: Both painterly outdoors, but Shinkai is hyper-saturated and photorealistic in the background; Ghibli is hand-painted.

vs Cinematic Anime: Shinkai is all about sky and atmosphere; Cinematic Anime is grounded in real-world equipment.

Dark & atmospheric

Shadow, dread, grand environments, moral weight

Kurosawa

monochrome · landscapes · moral weight

Desaturated or black-and-white. Lone figures against dramatic environments. Weather as emotional atmosphere.

vs Soulslike: Both grim, but Kurosawa is photographic film inspiration; Soulslike is fantasy concept art.

vs Crewdson: Kurosawa is outdoors, swept, grand; Crewdson is indoors, staged, hyperreal.

Crewdson

interior · staged · loaded stillness

Large-format photography aesthetic. Every element deliberately placed. Suburban or coastal interiors.

vs Kurosawa: Crewdson is interior, colour, hyper-composed; Kurosawa is outdoor, desaturated, elemental.

vs Editorial Fashion: Crewdson is emotionally loaded and unsettling; Editorial Fashion is aspirational and pristine.

Soulslike

gothic ruins · cursed characters · decay

FromSoftware concept art aesthetic. Grey, ash, muted teal. Grandeur and dread together. Fog everywhere.

vs Dark Fantasy: Dark Fantasy has jewel-tone vibrancy (emerald, crimson); Soulslike drains all saturation.

vs Miura: Soulslike is environment-first; Miura is all about the character — obsessive armour and crosshatching.

Dark Fantasy

epic · jewel tones · world-building

Brooding and saturated. Deep emerald, crimson, obsidian. Near-black backgrounds. Epic scale. Dangerous but visually gorgeous.

vs Soulslike: Dark Fantasy is vivid and saturated; Soulslike is desaturated and desolate. Same genre, opposite colour.

vs Ufotable: Both dark and dramatic, but Ufotable is anime action with particles; Dark Fantasy is static concept art.

Miura

Berserk · crosshatch · armour obsession

Dense precise crosshatching. Monochromatic or near-monochromatic. Obsessive structural detail. Feels engraved rather than drawn.

vs Soulslike: Miura is about the character's surface — every rivet; Soulslike is about the environment.

vs Ironbloom: Both armour-heavy, but Miura uses dense crosshatch and heavy blacks; Ironbloom uses clean lineart with white-background isolation.

Neon Noir

rain · cyberpunk · night city

Rain-slicked streets. Electric magenta, cyan, amber. Deep shadows, neon reflections. Mystery and dystopia.

vs Ufotable: Neon Noir is photographic urban night; Ufotable is anime action with particle and blade-light effects.

Velvet

crimson-violet · lustrous · dangerous elegance

Premium dark-fantasy anime. Signature crimson-violet palette. Glossy rendering on satin and silk. Luminous eyes.

vs Dark Fantasy: Dark Fantasy is environment and concept art; Velvet is a character portrait with luxury rendering.

vs Ufotable: Velvet is still, posed, and glossy; Ufotable is kinetic and motion-heavy.

Flat & minimal

No gradients, clean linework, restrained shading

Gossamer

iyashikei · healing · light novel CG

Nearly shadowless. Thin barely-visible lineart. Muted cool palette. Serene, elegant. Fixed aesthetic — you can't change the mood.

vs Flat Cel: Gossamer is Flat Cel locked to a specific mood and palette. Flat Cel lets you pick any colour and any genre.

vs Aquarelle: Gossamer is clean digital; Aquarelle has analog paper texture and warmth.

Flat Cel

universal · any genre · palette-free

The base flat technique with no mood or palette attached. One hard-edged shadow tone, lifted dark values. Use when you want flat rendering without Gossamer's serene aesthetic.

vs Gossamer: Flat Cel is the universal tool; Gossamer is Flat Cel pre-configured for healing and elegance.

vs Cel Shading: Flat Cel is anime digital; Cel Shading has bold black outlines and max saturation — louder, never quiet.

Cel Shading

graphic novel · bold outlines · poster energy

Bold black outlines, fully saturated flat fills, high-contrast shading. No gradients. The visual language of Borderlands and comic books.

vs Flat Cel: Cel Shading is louder — thick outlines, max saturation, poster composition. Flat Cel can be quiet. Cel Shading is never quiet.

Sketch Moe

bold G-pen · hand-drawn · semi-deformed

Bold G-pen outlines with natural pressure variation and subtle hand-drawn wobble. Soft flat fills, muted saturation. Semi-deformed proportions — between chibi and normal. Premium doujinshi cover art feel.

vs Gossamer / Flat Cel: All three use flat colouring, but Sketch Moe's bold G-pen outlines are the opposite of Gossamer's barely-visible lines and Flat Cel's clean thin lines.

vs Daily Chibi: Daily Chibi is locked to mundane slice-of-life; Sketch Moe is genre-free with any expression or scene type.

Chibi cluster

The four ways to make small characters — not interchangeable

Moe Gacha

extreme chibi · warm painterly · action

Full chibi (head = 1/3 to 1/2 body height). Warm golden atmospheric lighting with painted gradients. Soft particle effects. Any genre, always dynamic.

vs Flat Chibi: Same extreme proportions, different render. Moe Gacha is warm and painterly; Flat Chibi is flat cel — bold and graphic.

vs Gacha Splash: Moe Gacha is full-chibi; Gacha Splash is semi-chibi (head only slightly oversized).

Flat Chibi

extreme chibi · flat cel · user-defined palette

Same extreme chibi proportions as Moe Gacha. But rendered flat — one hard shadow edge, no gradients, no atmospheric glow. Palette and mood fully user-defined.

vs Moe Gacha: Same body, different finish. Warm cute and glowing = Moe Gacha. Flat bold and graphic = Flat Chibi.

Gacha Splash

semi-chibi · premium action · VTuber key visual

Head slightly oversized but not full-chibi. Dynamic action pose. Premium cinematic lighting with particles and bloom.

vs Moe Gacha: Gacha Splash has more realistic proportions and more dramatic character presence.

vs Ufotable: Both dynamic anime, but Gacha Splash has semi-chibi scale and gacha-game polish.

Daily Chibi

semi-chibi · slice-of-life · cozy mundane

Head about 1/4 of total height — mild chibi, not extreme. Always in a mundane context: eating, relaxing, a cafe. No action. Warmth and cosiness.

vs Moe Gacha: Daily Chibi is static and domestic; Moe Gacha is dynamic and action-ready.

vs Storybook: Daily Chibi is modern anime cosy; Storybook is illustrated fairy-tale with animal characters.

High-production anime

Action, drama, polish — each with a distinct visual signature

Ufotable

Demon Slayer · Fate · action key visual

Jewel-tone deep colours (crimson, electric blue, gold) against near-black. Particle trails, blade-light, supernatural glow. Kinetic and dramatic.

vs Cinematic Anime: Ufotable is supernatural action with colour-bloom; Cinematic Anime is grounded in realistic settings.

vs Shounen Burst: Both action, but Ufotable is polished jewel-tones; Shounen Burst has a warm sepia world being shattered.

Shounen Burst

power awakening · warm vs cold · urban destruction

Warm aged-paper world (sepia, bleached cream) colliding with cold or sharp supernatural force. The contrast between them is the whole image.

vs Ufotable: Shounen Burst has a warm-world-meets-cold-force tension that Ufotable doesn't.

vs Retro Anime: Shounen Burst looks modern but uses warm degraded tones; Retro Anime imitates 80s/90s production.

Cinematic Anime

grounded · real-world gear · studio lighting

High-production 2D anime with directional studio lighting. Characters with real-world equipment in grounded settings. Polished without being photorealistic.

vs Hyperreal Anime: Cinematic Anime stays illustrative — skin reads as painted. Hyperreal pushes skin to near-photographic texture.

vs Ufotable: Cinematic Anime is quiet and grounded; Ufotable is explosive and supernatural.

Hyperreal Anime

near-photographic · fantasy OC · portrait

Anime facial features (expressive eyes, pointed ears) with near-photographic everything else. Skin has actual texture — pores, freckles, sweat.

vs Cinematic Anime: The surface is the difference. Cinematic stays illustrative; Hyperreal crosses into photorealistic skin.

vs Editorial Fashion: Editorial is photography-aesthetic; Hyperreal is an anime character rendered to photograph-level detail.

Webtoon

Korean manhwa · fashion-forward · clean polish

Crisp consistent linework, slightly rounder and more fashion-forward than Japanese manga. Solo Leveling energy. Versatile across genres.

vs Cinematic Anime: Webtoon is clean linework and strong character presence; Cinematic has painterly rendering.

vs Retro Anime: Webtoon is hyper-clean and modern; Retro Anime intentionally degrades the image.

Retro Anime

80s–90s · film grain · Akira energy

Akira, Ghost in the Shell, Cowboy Bebop. Film grain, color bleed at edges, visible cel artifacts. Nostalgia is the point.

vs Webtoon: Webtoon is ultra-modern crisp; Retro Anime deliberately imitates analog degradation.

vs Shounen Burst: Retro uses actual 80s/90s production aesthetics; Shounen Burst uses warm degradation for emotional contrast.

Photographic & editorial

Rooted in real-world aesthetics, not anime

Editorial Fashion

luxury · minimal · commercial

Clean, controlled, hyper-intentional. Every prop placed. Vogue-era photography energy. No texture, no clutter, no accident.

vs Crewdson: Editorial Fashion is aspirational and clean; Crewdson is emotionally loaded and deliberately unsettling.

vs Prism: Prism adds refracted crystal light; Editorial Fashion is stripped back and minimal.

Prism

crystal · rainbow refraction · surreal luxury

Rainbow prism refractions scattered across the subject from crystal or gemstone elements. Hyper-detailed surreal luxury. The light itself is the spectacle.

vs Editorial Fashion: Both luxury-adjacent, but Prism adds surreal crystal-light effects; Editorial Fashion strips everything out.

vs Velvet: Prism is rainbow light on crystal; Velvet is crimson-violet gloss on fabric. Different materials, same polish tier.

Technical & specialised

Strong in one specific lane

Ironbloom

armour · mech · soft face vs hard machine

Soft anime face contrasted against hyper-detailed mechanical complexity — armour, mech suits, tactical gear. Two sub-moods: **Rendered** (earth tones, semi-flat shading, every surface detail) and **Flat/Ink** (flat colour fills, line economy, palette fully user-defined).

vs Miura: Both armour-focused, but Ironbloom isolates on a white background with clean lineart; Miura uses dense crosshatch and heavy blacks.

vs Cel Shading: The Flat/Ink sub-mood shares line economy with Cel Shading, but Ironbloom stays character-forward; Cel Shading goes full poster-graphic energy.

JRPG Pixel Art

fine-grid pixels · anime design · equipment detail

Not chunky retro pixels — high-res fine-grid where every pixel is intentional. Anime facial conventions in pixel form. Detailed equipment and expressive eyes.

vs everything else: This is the only pixel art style in the library. There is no substitute — use it when the grid constraint is the aesthetic choice.

Clean & polished

Confident linework, fabric detail, white-background character art

Pixiv Clean

gestural fabric · clean face · OC showcase

Confident medium-weight linework with deliberate contrast between face and fabric rendering. Fabric folds use loose, gestural inner lines; faces are smooth and luminous. White or near-absent background. Soft ambient lighting.

vs Flat Cel / Gossamer: Pixiv Clean uses 1–2 shadow passes with some volume; Flat Cel and Gossamer aim for near-shadowless.

vs Sketch Moe: Both are Pixiv-adjacent, but Pixiv Clean has clean controlled lines; Sketch Moe has bold G-pen wobble and semi-deformed proportions.